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APRIL 2026

**U/106/24-25/
AT00201/24-25/
35205**

Paper II – ENGLISH

Time : Three hours

Maximum : 100 marks

SECTION A — (10 × 2 = 20 marks)

Answer ALL the questions.

1. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) I don't can sing.
 - (b) They was watching TV when I arrived.
2. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) He seems be ill.
 - (b) I am agree with your opinion.
3. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) I play football tomorrow.
 - (b) He drive very carefully.

4. Complete the sentence using any, somebody, anybody, something or anything.
- (a) Is there _____ I can do?
- (b) _____ called you while you were out.
5. Put in the right kind of infinitive :
- (a) He doesn't like _____ while he's working. (interrupt)
- (b) It's necessary _____ the instructions carefully. (read)
6. Complete the following sentences with the correct tense of the verbs given in brackets
- (a) You _____ to see the doctor. (should, could, ought)
- (b) He _____ speak three languages fluently. (can, might, shall)
7. Give the synonyms of :
- (a) surveillance –
- (b) indigenous –

8. Give one-word substitute :

(a) a person who lives outside their native country.

(b) the process of making a garden or other piece of land more attractive

9. Use the word *drive* in a meaningful sentence.

10. Match the following words with their meanings :

S.No.	Words	Meanings
1.	fable	Principal character in a literary work
2.	protagonist	Short version of a story or tale that has a moral lesson, the characters are usually the animals
3.	plot	a direct and vivid comparison between two things usually considered distinct or unrelated
4.	metaphor	an opening to the story
		the sequence of events that make up a story

SECTION B — ($5 \times 7 = 35$ marks)

Answer ALL the questions in about 150 words.

11. Read the following passage and answer the questions given.

When the sun retreats below the dunes, the desert does not sleep—it transforms. The last rays burn orange across the sand, then fade into violet twilight. The heat of day escapes, carried off by a gentle wind that ruffles the dunes like waves on a sea of gold. As darkness deepens, the sky opens. Stars appear one by one, bright and sharp in the cold desert air. The Milky Way stretches overhead like a luminous river of light, and the horizon remains low and empty.

The landscape beneath is vast and silent. The dunes roll in soft curves, their crests catching the pale moonlight. Gravel and rock become silver-grey; shadows deepen to ink-black. A solitary cactus stands on a crest, its silhouette thin and tall against the horizon. The air smells of dry earth and ancient stone. Occasionally, a distant howl—perhaps a jackal—echoes in the emptiness, reminding you of life beyond the stillness.

This is a place where time seems to slow. Without the usual markers of minutes ticking, you might lose track of hours under the stars. The constellations wheel silently above; the planet Venus glows like a lamp and the desert breeze sings a whisper. In this moment, the world feels infinite—both earth and sky stretched wide. The dunes cradle the night, the stars keep watch, and you become a quiet witness to something timeless.

When dawn approaches, the sky shifts to pale rose, then to gold. Light spills across the dunes, sharp ridges cast deep shadows, and the cold desert night gives way to new heat. The night's silence still lingers, but it's changed: the desert wakes again. The vastness remains, but the perspective shifts, reminding you how small we are in comparison to the earth and the sky together.

- (a) What happens in the desert when the sun sets?
- (b) How does the desert look under the moonlight?
- (c) What sounds can be heard during the night?

- (d) What changes are seen when dawn approaches?
 - (e) Describe the air and the scent of the desert at night.
 - (f) What qualities of the desert make it beautiful according to the passage?
 - (g) The sand turns from gold to silver under the moonlight. This means
 - (i) The sand changes colour permanently
 - (ii) The moonlight makes the sand look silver
 - (iii) The sand is wet
 - (iv) The desert is glowing with fire
12. Write a postcard to your friend about attending a cultural festival or fair.
13. (a) Explain the steps taken by the Health Minister to flatten the corona virus in Kerala.

Or

- (b) Examine Kabul as a city in transition as depicted in “Returns”.

14. (a) Construct a paragraph on the contribution of Emmanuel Cosmos Msoka during Covid.

Or

- (b) Narrate the order of events as narrated by Malala on the fateful day she was shot.
15. (a) The poem ‘Consolation’ captures the poet, Billy Collins’ terrible disappointment at not being able to travel to Italy on a holiday. Justify.

Or

- (b) Evaluate the idea that Parle-G is more than just a biscuit but a shared emotion among Indians.

SECTION C — ($3 \times 15 = 45$ marks)

Answer the following in about 250 words.

16. Read the following story and answer the questions.

Little Mrs. Sommers one day found herself the unexpected possessor of fifteen dollars. It seemed a very large amount, and the way it bulged, her old purse gave her a sense of importance she had not felt for years. For two days she thought about how best to spend it. At night, she planned

carefully: new shoes for Janie, fabric for the children's clothes, hats for the boys and girls, and stockings for everyone. The vision of her children looking neat and fresh filled her with delight.

Mrs. Sommers had once known better days, but now her life was filled with household needs that left no time for reflection. She had learned the art of bargaining, waiting patiently for cheap goods and fighting her way through crowds to secure them.

That morning, she went shopping but was faint and tired, having forgotten to eat. She rested on a stool at a counter, her hand lying upon something soft and smooth – a pile of silk stockings. The touch of them was luxurious, and a sudden colour rose to her cheeks. A sign read *Reduced to one dollar and ninety-eight cents*. Almost without thinking, she asked for her size. There were many in black, blue, and grey. She examined a black pair closely, murmured, 'I'll take this pair,' and handed over a five-dollar bill.

The parcel seemed small in her worn shopping bag. Instead of heading for the bargain counter, Mrs. Sommers went to the ladies' waiting-room upstairs. In a quiet corner, she took off her old cotton stockings and put on the new silk ones.

She was not reasoning; she simply followed a strange impulse that freed her from responsibility. The smooth silk against her skin felt heavenly.

Next, she went straight to the shoe department and chose a pair of fine boots. The clerk, puzzled by her insistence on quality, could not guess her story. She admired her foot and ankle-they looked elegant, almost unfamiliar.

At the glove counter, she allowed a young woman to fit her hands with soft, well-made gloves-a luxury she had long denied herself. The sight of her gloved hands filled her with quiet satisfaction. Leaving the store, she passed a newsstand and bought two expensive magazines like those she had once read long ago. Her appearance – new shoes, gloves, and stockings-gave her confidence. She felt as though she belonged to the world of well-dressed women passing around her.

Soon she realized she was hungry. Normally, she would have waited until home to make tea, but today, impulse ruled. She entered a fine restaurant she had only admired from outside. She was seated at a small table, treated

respectfully by the waiter. She ordered oysters, a tender chop, something sweet, a glass of wine, and coffee. She removed her gloves, glanced through a magazine, and felt the silk on her legs as she sipped and read. Everything seemed perfect – the spotless linen, shining glassware, and soft music. When she finished, she paid without concern, even leaving a coin for the waiter, who bowed deeply as if before a lady of wealth.

Walking out, she saw a theatre poster. A matinée! The temptation was irresistible. Soon she sat among elegantly dressed women, watching the play. She laughed and cried with them, completely absorbed. A richly dressed woman beside her shared candy with her, and for a short while, Mrs. Sommers was one of them-carefree, refined, alive.

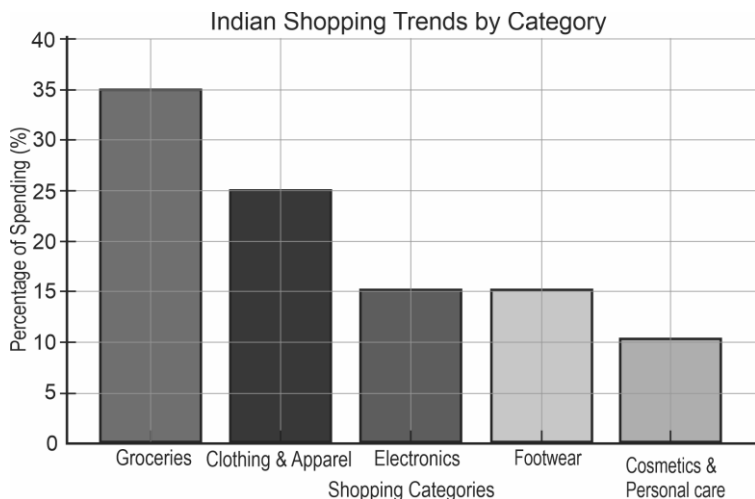
When the play ended, the magic began to fade. Outside, she waited for the cable car. A man seated opposite her studied her pale, thoughtful face. He could not read what was in it - perhaps a desperate longing that the car would go on and on, never stopping, carrying her forever away from the world to which she must return.

Questions :

- (a) What is the gist of the story? (2)
- (b) What did Mrs. Sommers plan to do with the fifteen dollars she found? (2)
- (c) State whether the following statements are True or False. (4)
 - (i) Mrs. Sommers wanted to buy clothes for herself from the very beginning.
 - (ii) She forgot to eat lunch before going shopping.
 - (iii) Mrs. Sommers bought a pair of silk stockings on impulse.
 - (iv) At the end of the story, Mrs. Sommers wished the cable car would never stop.
- (d) Arrange the following sentences in the correct order. (2)
 - (i) Mrs. Sommers went to the restaurant and ordered oysters, a chop, and wine.
 - (ii) She bought a pair of silk stockings and put them on in the ladies' waiting room.

- (iii) She attended a matinée and enjoyed the play with other well-dressed women.
- (iv) She bought magazines and felt confident walking among fashionable people.
- (e) Match the words/terms with their meanings. (3)
- | S.No. | Words | Meanings |
|-------|---------|--|
| 1. | Luxury | a play or performance held in the daytime |
| 2. | Matinée | a sudden strong desire to act without thinking |
| 3. | Impulse | great comfort or elegance, especially when involving expense |
- (f) Complete the sentences with the correct option. (2)
- (i) The feel of the _____ stockings gave Mrs. Sommers a sense of pleasure and luxury.
(cotton/silk/wool/nylon)
- (ii) Mrs. Sommers' shopping trip reflected her brief escape from a life of _____.
(wealth/responsibility/poverty/comfort)

17. (a) Write a brief report based on the bar diagram presented below. (5)



- (b) Write a bio-sketch of your favourite national leader. (10)

18. (a) Discuss how the author's passion for travel in the essay '*On Searching for a Once-Lost Love*' motivated him to explore the diversity of India.

Or

- (b) Analyze the hardships faced by Chris Gardner and his son in *The Pursuit of Happyness*.
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